PODPIS ZAUFANY
RAJMUND TADEUSZ
OLSZEWSKI
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The Random Walk of Critical Systems: Bounded Control, The Three-State Balance Scale, and the Elimination of Stochastic Drift

Author: Rajmund Olszewski

Affiliation: Independent Researcher, Critical Infrastructure OT / L0 Systems

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Abstract

In complex operational environments—from high-density liquid cooling loops (mCDU) to power grids and autonomous systems—uncontrolled variables inevitably induce a stochastic random walk. Without structural intervention, cumulative micro-deviations guarantee eventual catastrophic failure (the -1 absorbing barrier). Contemporary artificial intelligence attempts to compute this drift using massive parameter spaces, introducing severe latency and operational vulnerability. This paper proposes a reductionist architecture that abandons continuous vector approximation in favor of a discrete, three-state balance scale paradigm (+1 normative stability, 0 neutral reference, -1 critical boundary). By enforcing hard physical and logical boundaries on a constrained state space, we eliminate probabilistic drift and ensure absolute operational safety in L0 infrastructure.

1. The Inevitability of the Random Walk in Physical Infrastructure

Every physical or cyber-physical system left without continuous structural governance is subject to microscopic fluctuations. Mathematically, these accumulated perturbations behave as a random walk.

- In cloud-based AI, stochastic drift is masked by semantic interpolation.
- In L0 operational technology (OT)—such as managing pressure differentials and thermal profiles in Direct-to-Chip cooling—a random walk unchecked by hard limits results in structural failure, cavitation, or system rupture.

Attempting to solve this drift by scaling neural network parameters is an engineering fallacy. More parameters do not stop a random walk; they merely increase the complexity of the path toward failure.

2. The Three-State Balance Scale: +1, 0, -1

If we discard the illusion of absolute prediction and return to foundational logic, the entire state space of a critical asset can be mapped to three discrete conditions:

1. **+1 (Normative Equilibrium):**
2. **0 (The Neutral Reference):**
3. **-1 (The Critical Boundary / Absorbing Barrier):**

Unlike probabilistic models that output continuous, unverified probabilities, a true L0 safety architecture forces every operational vector through a discrete evaluation: does this action push the system toward +1 or does it trigger the -1 boundary?

3. Bounded Control as an Absorbing Barrier

The primary function of an edge orchestration layer is not to "think" or "learn," but to act as a **physical and logical absorbing barrier**.

- Even if an underlying cognitive engine (or local language model) exhibits erratic or stochastic tendencies, it is treated merely as a source of unvalidated drift.
- The invariant core interdicts any vector attempting to cross the -1 boundary.
- By reducing multi-dimensional complexity into a rigid ternary decision framework, the system achieves instant determinism (< 1\ms response time), perfectly matching the physical realities of industrial actuators and PLC controllers.

4. Conclusion

Security in critical infrastructure does not stem from infinite computational power, but from absolute structural constraints. By recognizing that systems naturally undergo a random walk toward failure, we can design control frameworks modeled on the elemental simplicity of a balance scale. Constraining operations between +1 and -1 provides the mathematical armor required to safely integrate localized intelligence into high-risk physical environments.